



2026 Revenue Leak Audit Checklist

Is Your Practice Losing \$5,000+ Every Month to Preventable Denials?

Use this 10-minute diagnostic tool to evaluate your current billing performance. If you answer "No" or "Unsure" to more than two questions, your revenue cycle is leaking.

1. The 48-Hour Submission Rule

- **The Goal:** 95% of claims should be scrubbed and submitted within 48 hours of the Date of Service (DOS).
- **The Leak:** Claims submitted 7+ days after the visit have a 12% higher chance of being denied for "Timely Filing" or "Eligibility Expiry."
- **Audit Question:** Does your current biller submit yesterday's claims today?

2. First-Pass Clean Claim Rate (CCR)

- **The Goal:** A healthy CCR is 97% or higher.
- **The Leak:** If your CCR is 85% or lower, you are paying for "re-work." Every denied claim costs an average of **\$25.00** just to resubmit.
- **Audit Question:** What was your exact CCR on last month's Payer Report?

3. The "A/R Over 90" Red Zone

- **The Goal:** No more than 12–15% of your total Accounts Receivable should be older than 90 days.
- **The Leak:** Once a claim hits 120 days, the probability of collecting falls to less than 20%. This is where revenue goes to die.
- **Audit Question:** Is your biller actively working the "Old A/R" daily, or just "cherry-picking" new claims?

4. Real-Time Eligibility (RTE) Verification

- **The Goal:** 100% of patient insurance must be verified *before* the provider enters the room.
- **The Leak:** "Patient Not Covered" is the #1 denial reason in 2026. Collecting at the front desk is 300% more effective than sending a statement later.
- **Audit Question:** Do you have a documented workflow for verifying secondary and tertiary coverage before the visit?

5. Modifier Precision (NCCI Edits)

- **The Goal:** Accurate use of modifiers like **-25**, **-59**, and the new **-XS** or **-XP** suffixes.
- **The Leak:** Overusing modifiers triggers OIG audits; underusing them leads to unpaid procedures.
- **Audit Question:** Does your biller stay updated on the quarterly NCCI (National Correct Coding Initiative) edit updates?

6. Payer-Specific Denial Intelligence

- **The Goal:** Monthly "Top 5 Denial" root-cause analysis reports.
- **The Leak:** If you don't know *why* Aetna or UnitedHealthcare is denying your specific CPT codes, you can't fix the clinical documentation to stop it.
- **Audit Question:** Does your biller provide a monthly strategy meeting to discuss denial trends?

7. Credentialing & Enrollment Maintenance

- **The Goal:** Zero claim rejections due to expired CAQH or payer enrollment.
- **The Leak:** A single provider falling out of network for 30 days can cost a practice **\$20,000+** in non-reimbursable visits.
- **Audit Question:** Is there a dedicated system tracking your re-credentialing deadlines?

The Verdict:

If you found leaks in your practice, you don't have a volume problem—you have a **Revenue Cycle Problem**.

Ready for a Professional Deep-Dive? Contact **Enhancebilling** for a complimentary 30-day practice audit. We don't just process claims; we recover lost revenue.

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